

replacement. Soon, the currently used frequencies of 88 to 108 MHz were allotted to FM and FM started gaining in popularity. Until the 1970s FM remained merely an alternative to AM, with service providers often transmitting the same programming on both AM and FM simultaneously. This practice was called simulcasting. By the 1980s, with all new radio receiver sets also being equipped with FM capabilities, FM had all but replaced AM in cities. AM however continues to be used, to this day, in rural environments.

Some examples of FM stations in India are Radio Indigo and Radio Mirchi.

The large bandwidth allotted to FM radio has allowed it to be used for other purposes as well. Some broadcasters use this extra capacity for transmitting background music for public places, financial market data for wireless stock tickers, and auxiliary GPS signals.

Aside from AM and FM, a few other technologies for radio broadcasting exist. Chief among them is digital radio, otherwise known as digital audio broadcasting. This technology utilises digital modulation techniques. However it has not gained much popularity and is not expected to do so. A more popular alternative radio technology is satellite radio. Slowly developing, this technology combines digital modulation techniques with satellite based transmission. Allowing for high quality radio, and many allied services, the only drawback of this technology is its relatively high cost, thanks to the requirement of reception apparatus similar to that which is required for satellite TV. In India, the only established satellite radio provider is WorldSpace



The worldspace satellite radio receiver